Learn French with Paul Noble

REVIEW BOOKLET

Collins

This booklet provides you with a quick and easy way to review and reinforce what you have learned during your audio course.

The booklet should be used after you have begun working through the audio course, as it is not designed to teach you French by itself.

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The Paul Noble Method

Over the years, I have taught many, many people. Curiously, they have each had much the same story to tell regarding their previous experiences of language learning. As a result, these days, when I first start a teaching session, I ask my students to raise their hands if they have had any of the following experiences.

Raise your hand, I say:

- **If you studied a language for several years at school but came out unable to really say anything.**
- **If you have ever bought a language course and given up around page thirty, somewhere around chapter two.**
- **If you have ever felt more confused by a teacher's explanation of the language than by the language itself.**
- **If you have ever been amazed by just how closely grammar books resemble furniture assembly instructions.**
- **If you have ever felt that you may in fact be more or less incapable of learning a foreign language.**

Invariably, all the students soon have at least one hand in the air – and they laugh. They laugh because for some reason our language-learning experiences tend to be very similar and, sadly, these similar experiences tend not to be very good ones.

My own initial experiences of language learning were also uncannily similar to those described above. In fact, when I ask my students these questions, my own hand is the first to go up – and it stays up until we have gone through them all.

However, these less-than-positive experiences have had an upside both for myself and for those individuals I have taught because they, along with a number of other factors, have helped inform and shape the method that will be used during this course.

Using this method, you will learn how to communicate in French and how to formulate your own ideas and thoughts using French.

As you learn with it, you will quickly discover that I do not use complicated grammatical explanations *at all*, and I will not ask you to memorise long lists of vocabulary – the way the course is structured will by itself ensure that you remember what you are taught. Instead, through your interaction with the audio, I will lead you through the French language, enabling you to build up complex sentences by yourself, step by step, so that you are actually speaking independently in French by the end of the course. And this is regardless of how little, or how much, you know when you begin.

You will also discover that the language I teach is designed to be adaptable, so that you will be able to use it just as easily for holidaying in a French-speaking country as for living or working in one; it will be just as easy to use it to order a coffee as to hold a conversation with the waiter who brings it to you. And, again, all of this regardless of how little, or how much, you know when you begin.

At the time of writing, this method has already proved extremely successful with a very great many students, including hundreds of so-called "no-hopers". Interestingly, not one of these students failed to learn using this method. It is these many success cases and thank-you letters – and even the occasional hug – that have made teaching languages so very worthwhile for me and it is this which has persuaded me to publish my courses here, for the first time.

I anticipate and hope that they will be as effective for you as they have been for so many of my other students.

Au revoir – and good luck!

Paul Noble

Paul Noble
Head of the Paul Noble Language Institute

How to use this booklet

This booklet has been designed to provide you with a quick and easy way to review and reinforce the key vocabulary, structures and contents of your Paul Noble Method French course.

Although the core part of your learning will take place via your use of the accompanying course audio, we have also included this booklet in order to provide you with a quick reference guide to the language, as well as a way to begin to get to grips with both reading and writing French, should you wish to do so.

It is worth noting that this booklet should be used after you have begun working through the accompanying audio. It will serve as excellent reinforcement, guidance and review material but is not designed to teach you French by itself. This is what the audio will do – and very rapidly, too. After you have begun working through the audio, you will find this booklet to be an extremely useful review and reference resource, but you must start by listening to the audio.

So, if you haven't done so already, go and start playing the audio. You are about to find out just how good a course this is!

Creating French words

Use these conversion techniques to create several thousand French words out of English.

Words ending in... in English	become... in French	Examples
ion	***stay the same***	**transformation** **information** **invitation**
age	***stay the same***	**cage** **bandage** **courage**
ade	***stay the same***	**parade** **barricade** **escapade**
ude	***stay the same***	**attitude** **gratitude** **solitude**
ure	***stays the same***	**agriculture** **sculpture** **signature**
ible/able	***stay the same***	**possible** **terrible** **table**
ant/ent	***stay the same***	**important** **intelligent** **excellent**
um	***stay the same***	**album** **maximum** **minimum**

Words ending in... in English	become... in French	Examples
ary	**aire**	ordinary = **ordinaire** salary = **salaire** solitary = **solitaire**
ory	**oire**	glory = **gloire** history = **histoire** victory = **victoire**
ic/ical	**ique**	political = **politique** typical = **typique** magic = **magique**
id	**ide**	candid = **candide** stupid = **stupide** timid = **timide**
sm	**sme**	optimism = **optimisme** pacifism = **pacifisme** sarcasm = **sarcasme**
ty	**té**	publicity = **publicité** activity = **activité** quality = **qualité**
or	**eur**	doctor = **docteur** actor = **acteur** pastor = **pasteur**
ist	**iste**	artist = **artiste** pianist = **pianiste** fascist = **fasciste**
ian	**ien** (*m*) / **ienne** (*f*)	optician = **opticien** musician = **musicien** Parisian = **Parisien**
ive	**if** (*m*) / **ive** (*f*)	active = **actif / active** captive = **captif / captive** massive = **massif / massive**

Core course review

The best way to use this part of your booklet is to start by reading through a page, looking at both the English and the French. Then go back to the beginning of that same page and, while covering the French side of the text, translate the English into French – just as you did when you listened to the course audio.

Once you can get 90% of a page's content correct, move on to the next page and follow the process again. By doing this, you will quickly recall and reinforce what you learnt with the audio tracks.

The past (using "have")

I	**Je**
have	**ai**
I have	**J'ai**

NOTE! Notice that, as there would be two vowels touching in **Je ai**, it contracts instead to **J'ai** – this is a common occurrence in French and one that you will quickly get used to.

visited	**visité**
the Louvre	**le Louvre**
I have visited the Louvre.	**J'ai visité le Louvre.**
the park	**le parc**
I have visited the park.	**J'ai visité le parc.**
prepared	**préparé**
I have prepared	**J'ai préparé**
the coffee	**le café**
I have prepared the coffee.	**J'ai préparé le café.**
for you	**pour vous**
I have prepared the coffee for you.	**J'ai préparé le café pour vous.**

English words which end in "ion" came into English through French. There are 1250 of them. If you know them in English, then you can use them in French.

reservation	**réservation**
invitation	**invitation**
decoration	**décoration**

If you take an "ion" word, such as **préparation**, cut off the "**ation**" on the end and add a café "**é**" in its place, you will have a word like **préparé**, which means *prepared*. This means you can now say: I have prepared, I have visited, I have decorated etc. Try the example below:

preparation	**préparation**

Now, cut off the "**ation**", which leaves you with "**prépar**", and then add a café "**é**". You will end up with **préparé**, which means *prepared*.

I have prepared	**J'ai préparé**
I have visited	**J'ai visité**
decoration	**décoration**
I have decorated	**J'ai décoré**
the house	**la maison**

NOTE! One of the best things about French, and one way in which it is easier than English, is that in order to talk about the past, you don't need to use as many different tenses as you would in English.

For instance, take the following sentences in English: *I have decorated the house*, *I decorated the house*, *I did decorate the house*. In French, these are all expressed in the same way, simply as: *I have decorated the house*, which in French is: **J'ai décoré la maison**. The above three sentences can therefore be served by the same single tense in French.

Have a go at this using the following three prompts:

I've decorated the house.	**J'ai décoré la maison.**
I decorated the house.	**J'ai décoré la maison.**
I did decorate the house.	**J'ai décoré la maison.**

You see, they are all the same! This is excellent news, as it means you don't need to worry about switching between tenses when talking about events in the past in French.

reservation	**réservation**
reserved	**réservé**
I have reserved	**J'ai réservé**
I have reserved a table.	**J'ai réservé une table.**
You have	**Vous avez**

You have reserved a table.	**Vous avez réservé une table.**
We have	**Nous avons**
We have reserved a table.	**Nous avons réservé une table.**
He has	**Il a**
He has reserved a table.	**Il a réservé une table.**
She has	**Elle a**
She has reserved a table.	**Elle a réservé une table**.
You have (*inf.*)	**Tu as**
You have reserved a table. (*inf.*)	**Tu as réservé une table.**
They have	**Ils ont**
They have reserved a table.	**Ils ont réservé une table.**
They have (*female group*)	**Elles ont**
They have reserved a table.	**Elles ont réservé une table.**

NOTE! As you may have noticed above, there are two words for *they* in French. Normally, you will use **ils** for *they*. However, if you are talking about an entirely, 100%, female group – a group of five women, for example – you should use **elles**. If the group is male, or partly male, however, you will use **ils** – which is more or less the default form. Even if a group contained 99 women and just 1 man, you would still use **ils**.

This is not something to worry or think too much about, though, and if in doubt use **ils**!

Asking questions in the past

There are several ways to ask questions in French. Let's start by simply inverting the word order, as we do in English.

Inverting the word order

You have	**Vous avez**
Have you?	**Avez-vous?**
Have you visited?	**Avez-vous visité?**
Did you visit?	**Avez-vous visité?**

Notice that the above two phrases are both translated in the same way in French.

Did you visit the Louvre?	**Avez-vous visité le Louvre?**
Yes, I visited the Louvre.	**Oui, j'ai visité le Louvre.**
Have you visited the park?	**Avez-vous visité le parc?**
Have you prepared the coffee?	**Avez-vous préparé le café?**
Have you prepared roast beef for dinner?	**Avez-vous préparé le rosbif pour le dîner?**

NOTE! Notice how the French use the words for **the** in French (**le**/**la**/**les**) more than we use *the* in English. You can see this in the above example. Literally: *Have you prepared* ***the*** *roast beef for* ***the*** *dinner?* The best way to get used to this is simply to remember the French word with the "the" already attached to it and then use it in that way. So think of *dinner* not as **dîner** but as **le dîner**, and think of *roast beef* not as **rosbif** but as **le rosbif**.

Have you decorated the house?	**Avez-vous décoré la maison?**
Did you decorate the house?	**Avez-vous décoré la maison?**
Have you reserved a table for dinner?	**Avez-vous réservé une table pour le dîner?**
We have	**Nous avons**
Have we?	**Avons-nous?**

Have we reserved a table for dinner?	**Avons-nous réservé une table pour le dîner?**
Have we visited the Louvre?	**Avons-nous visité le Louvre?**

Using "est-ce que...?"

Another way to ask a question in French is to put **est-ce que...?** (literally: *is it that...?*) in front of a statement.

We have reserved a table.	**Nous avons réservé une table.**
Have we reserved a table?	**Est-ce que nous avons réservé une table?**
You have decorated the house.	**Vous avez décoré la maison**.
Have you decorated the house?	**Est-ce que vous avez décoré la maison?**

Using a rising intonation

Another way to ask a question is to use a rising intonation, as we do in English. However, this is used far more frequently in French than it is in English. To ask a question this way, simply raise the pitch of your voice at the end of the sentence.

Try the examples below. First say the sentence as a statement, and then try again, this time raising your pitch at the end to change it into a question.

He has reserved a table.	**Il a réservé une table.**
Has he reserved a table?	**Il a réservé une table?**
They have prepared roast beef for dinner.	**Ils ont préparé le rosbif pour le dîner**.
Have they prepared roast beef for dinner?	**Ils ont préparé le rosbif pour le dîner?**

NOTE! Although a rising intonation is used very frequently in speech in order to ask a question in French, it is not normally used in writing. Why? Well, simply because the reader cannot hear you when you raise your pitch at the end of the sentence, can they? So, when writing, use **est-ce que...?** or invert the word order.

Using "it" in the past

I have prepared.	**J'ai préparé.**
I have prepared it.	**Je l'ai préparé.**

NOTE! Notice how, unlike in English, the "it" goes before "have" – not after it. For this, keep in mind the simple rule you learnt during the course: "have" always steals the pronouns and places them directly in front of itself. (Pronouns are little words like *it*, *me*, *you*, *us*, *him*, *her*, *them*.)

You have prepared.	**Vous avez préparé.**
You prepared it.	**Vous l'avez préparé.**
We have prepared it.	**Nous l'avons préparé.**
to buy	**acheter**
bought	**acheté**
We have bought it.	**Nous l'avons acheté.**
He has bought it.	**Il l'a acheté.**
to understand	**comprendre**
understood	**compris**
He has understood it.	**Il l'a compris.**
She has understood it.	**Elle l'a compris.**
You have understood it. (*inf.*) ➜1	**Tu l'as compris.**
to eat	**manger**
eaten	**mangé**
They have eaten it.	**Ils l'ont mangé.**
They have eaten it. (*female group*)	**Elles l'ont mangé.**

➜ **JARGON BUSTER 1**

Inf. = informal (referring here to the **tu** form of address used when talking to family, close friends and children).

Using "some/any" in the past

I have eaten it.	**Je l'ai mangé.**
some / some of it / any / any of it	**en**
I have eaten some of it.	**J'en ai mangé.**
to find	**trouver**
found	**trouvé**
They have found it.	**Ils l'ont trouvé.**
They have found some of it.	**Ils en ont trouvé.**
He has found some of it.	**Il en a trouvé.**
She has found some of it.	**Elle en a trouvé.**
You have found some of it. (*inf.*)	**Tu en as trouvé.**
You have found some of it.	**Vous en avez trouvé.**
Have you found some of it?	**Est-ce que vous en avez trouvé?**

Using negatives in the past

I have	**J'ai**
I have prepared.	**J'ai préparé.**
I have prepared it.	**Je l'ai préparé.**
I haven't prepared it.	**Je ne l'ai pas préparé.**
I didn't prepare it.	**Je ne l'ai pas préparé.**
You haven't prepared it.	**Vous ne l'avez pas préparé.**
You didn't prepare it.	**Vous ne l'avez pas préparé.**
You didn't prepare any (of it).	**Vous n'en avez pas préparé.**
You didn't find it.	**Vous ne l'avez pas trouvé.**
We didn't find it.	**Nous ne l'avons pas trouvé.**
We didn't find any (of it).	**Nous n'en avons pas trouvé.**
to buy	**acheter**
bought	**acheté**
We didn't buy it.	**Nous ne l'avons pas acheté.**
to sell	**vendre**
sold	**vendu**
We didn't sell it.	**Nous ne l'avons pas vendu.**
to see	**voir**

seen	**vu**
We didn’t see it.	**Nous ne l’avons pas vu.**
We didn’t understand it.	**Nous ne l’avons pas compris.**
He didn’t understand it.	**Il ne l’a pas compris.**
She didn’t understand it.	**Elle ne l’a pas compris.**
me	**me**
She didn’t understand me.	**Elle ne m’a pas compris.**
They didn’t understand me.	**Ils ne m’ont pas compris.**
to wait	**attendre**
waited	**attendu**
They didn’t wait for you.	**Ils ne vous ont pas attendu.**
They didn’t wait for me.	**Ils ne m’ont pas attendu.**
He didn’t wait for me.	**Il ne m’a pas attendu.**

The past (using "to be")

Sometimes in French, you cannot use "have" for the past tense. Instead, you need to use a form of "to be". This occurs when you use a verb ➜ **2** in the past that involves going or coming ***in any sense***.

So, when you are talking about going, coming, arriving, departing, going out, going up, coming down, being born (coming into the world) or dying (going out of the world), you will use "to be" to form the past tense – ***not*** "to have".

Therefore, to say in French that *he has gone / he went* you will literally say "he is gone". To say *she has arrived / she arrived* you will say "she is arrived". To say *he has left / he left* you will say "he is left". This is, however, ***only*** for verbs that involve going or coming in some sense. ➜ **3** Let's look at an example:

I am	**Je suis**
to arrive	**arriver**
arrived	**arrivé / arrivée / arrivés / arrivées**
I have arrived.	**Je suis arrivé / arrivée.**
We are	**Nous sommes**
We have arrived.	**Nous sommes arrivés / arrivées.**

Before moving on, it is probably worth explaining why "arrived" is spelt in four different ways above – and sometimes in two different ways in a single sentence!

The first point to make is that, when speaking, this spelling difference doesn't matter because all four spellings are pronounced in exactly the same way: **arrivé**. However, if you decide that you wish to learn to write French, you will need to be aware that the spelling for "arrived" changes according to what I like to call "***the fiancé rule***".

JARGON BUSTER 2

What is a verb? An easy way to identify a verb is to see if you can put "I", "he" or "we" directly in front of it. If you can, it is a verb. For example: I go, he eats, we fly, I buy, he thinks, we leave. All the underlined words are verbs; you know this because you can put "I", "he" or "we" ***directly in front of them***.

JARGON BUSTER 3

The exception to the 'coming and going' rule is **rester**, meaning *to stay*. After going or coming somewhere, of course, you would need somewhere to stay, which may help you to remember this.

The fiancé rule

You may well be thinking: what on earth is this? Well, we all know what a fiancé is: a person someone is engaged to. In English, a male person you are engaged to is spelt *fiancé*. However, a female person you are engaged to is spelt *fiancée* with an extra "e" on the end.

This fiancé/fiancée rule happens to apply to all verbs in French when they are used with "to be" to form the past tense. Let's look at an example:

I have arrived. (*said by a man*)	**Je suis arrivé.**
I have arrived. (*said by a woman*)	**Je suis arrivée.**

You can see how, although it is **arrivé** for a man who has arrived, it is **arrivée** for a woman, with an extra "**e**" on the end. This is just the same as for *fiancé/fiancée* – fiancé for a man but fiancée, with an extra "e", for a woman.

As stated earlier, however, it is only for this group of "going and coming" verbs (which use "to be" to form the past tense) that there is this difference. Normal verbs, which use "have" to form the past tense, are the same no matter who they refer to. Take a look:

I have eaten. (*said by a man*)	**J'ai mangé.**
I have eaten. (*said by a woman*)	**J'ai mangé.**

You see? They are the same – and they never change!

The fiancé rule doesn't simply stop here, however. In English, if you are engaged to one male person, he is your *fiancé*. If you're engaged to one female person, she is your *fiancée*. What would happen, however, if you were very naughty and were simultaneously engaged to two people? Well, it works like anything else in English: you add an "s".

I have one book.	***but*** I have two books.
I have one male fiancé.	***but*** I have two male fiancés.
I have one female fiancée.	***but*** I have two female fiancées.

Now let's see this in action in French:

I have arrived. (*said by a man*)	**Je suis arrivé.**
We have arrived. (*said by two men*)	**Nous sommes arrivés.**
I have arrived. (*said by a woman*)	**Je suis arrivée.**
We have arrived. (*said by two women*)	**Nous sommes arrivées.**

So, if you are familiar with the English word "fiancé", you now know the fiancé rule and so can write very sophisticated, advanced and, crucially, ***correct*** French.

The fiancé rule shows you how to write the correct endings, depending on ***who*** it is that has arrived, gone, left etc. Let's look at this through a series of examples:

I have arrived. (*said by a man*)	**Je suis arrivé.**
We have arrived. (*said by two men*)	**Nous sommes arrivés.**

I have arrived. (*said by a woman*)	**Je suis arrivée.**
We have arrived. (*said by two women*)	**Nous sommes arrivées.**
You are	**Vous êtes**
You have arrived. (*said to one man*)	**Vous êtes arrivé.**
You have arrived. (*said to two men*)	**Vous êtes arrivés.**
You have arrived. (*said to one woman*)	**Vous êtes arrivée.**
You have arrived. (*said to two women*)	**Vous êtes arrivées.**

NOTE! Again, be aware that the spelling of "arrived" alters according to ***who*** it is that has arrived and always according to ***the fiancé rule***.

Now take a look at these other verbs below and simply apply the rule in exactly the same way.

to go	**aller**
gone	**allé / allée / allés / allées**
I have gone. (*said by a man*)	**Je suis allé.**
I have gone. (*said by a woman*)	**Je suis allée.**
We have gone. (*said by two men*)	**Nous sommes allés.**
We have gone. (*said by two women*)	**Nous sommes allées.**
You are	**Vous êtes**
You have gone. (*said to one man*)	**Vous êtes allé.**
You have gone. (*said to one woman*)	**Vous êtes allée.**
You have gone. (*said to two men*)	**Vous êtes allés.**
You have gone. (*said to two women*)	**Vous êtes allées.**
to come	**venir**
came	**venu / venue / venus / venues**
He came yesterday.	**Il est venu hier.**
She came this morning.	**Elle est venue ce matin.**
to leave	**partir**
left	**parti / partie / partis / parties**
He left yesterday evening.	**Il est parti hier soir.**
She left this evening.	**Elle est partie ce soir.**

The present

Using "it is"

Words ending in "-ic" and "-ical" in English end in "**-ique**" in French.

typical	**typique**
exotic	**exotique**
political	**politique**
It is	**C'est**
It is typical!	**C'est typique!**
It is exotic!	**C'est exotique!**
It is political!	**C'est politique!**
It is not	**Ce n'est pas**
It is not political!	**Ce n'est pas politique!**
It is not exotic!	**Ce n'est pas exotique!**

Talking about what you would like to, want to, can and must do

"I would like to..."

I would like	**Je voudrais**
I would like to prepare the dinner.	**Je voudrais préparer le dîner.**
with you	**avec vous**
I would like to prepare the dinner with you.	**Je voudrais préparer le dîner avec vous.**
I would like to prepare the dinner because	**Je voudrais préparer le dîner parce que**
I'm hungry (I have hunger).	**J'ai faim.**

NOTE! You will probably remember, from your time with the audio, that the "**m**" at the end of **faim** is not clearly pronounced but rather is only touched on nasally. This is because, in general, consonants on the very end of French words are not pronounced unless they are in ***FoR LuCK***.

I would like to prepare the coffee because	**Je voudrais préparer le café parce que**
I am thirsty (I have thirst).	**J'ai soif.**

NOTE! By contrast, the "**f**" on the end of **soif** ***is*** pronounced because it ***is*** in ***FoR LuCK***.

I would like to prepare the coffee for you.	**Je voudrais préparer le café pour vous.**
I would like to prepare the roast beef for (the) dinner.	**Je voudrais préparer le rosbif pour le dîner.**
I would like to reserve a table.	**Je voudrais réserver une table.**
I would like to reserve a table for dinner.	**Je voudrais réserver une table pour le dîner.**
to know	**savoir**
I would like to know	**Je voudrais savoir**
if	**si**
I would like to know if it is possible.	**Je voudrais savoir si c'est possible.**
you want	**vous voulez**
you want it	**vous le voulez**
I would like to know if you want it.	**Je voudrais savoir si vous le voulez.**
I would like to know if you want some (of it).	**Je voudrais savoir si vous en voulez.**
why	**pourquoi**
I would like to know why you want some (of it).	**Je voudrais savoir pourquoi vous en voulez.**
I would like to know why it is possible.	**Je voudrais savoir pourquoi c'est possible.**
I would like to know why it is not possible.	**Je voudrais savoir pourquoi ce n'est pas possible.**

"want"

there	**là**
I want to go there.	**Je veux aller là.**

It is possible (and in fact usual) in French to replace **là** with **y**, which also means *there*. Let's look at both:

to go there (*using* **là**)	**aller là**
to go there (*using* **y**)	**y aller**
I want to go there.	**Je veux y aller.**
I want to go there with you.	**Je veux y aller avec vous.**
I don't want to go there.	**Je ne veux pas y aller.**
You don't want to go there. (*inf.*)	**Tu ne veux pas y aller.**
He wants to go there.	**Il veut y aller.**
She wants to go there.	**Elle veut y aller.**
to eat	**manger**
She wants to eat.	**Elle veut manger.**
We want to eat.	**Nous voulons manger.**
You want to eat.	**Vous voulez manger.**
They want to eat.	**Ils veulent manger.**
They want to eat. (*female group*)	**Elles veulent manger.**

NOTE! Don't forget that **veulent** is pronounced "vurl". The letters "**ent**" are silent here, as they are whenever "**ent**" comes at the end of a verb that follows "they".

They don't want to eat.	**Ils ne veulent pas manger.**
They don't want to eat it.	**Ils ne veulent pas le manger.**
I want to know why they don't want to eat it.	**Je veux savoir pourquoi ils ne veulent pas le manger.**
I want to know why they don't want to eat any of it.	**Je veux savoir pourquoi ils ne veulent pas en manger.**

"can"

I can go there with you.	**Je peux y aller avec vous.**
I can go there this evening.	**Je peux y aller ce soir.**
I cannot go there this evening.	**Je ne peux pas y aller ce soir.**
You cannot go there this evening. (*inf.*)	**Tu ne peux pas y aller ce soir.**
He can go there this evening.	**Il peut y aller ce soir.**

He cannot go there this evening.	**Il ne peut pas y aller ce soir.**
We can go there this evening.	**Nous pouvons y aller ce soir.**
We cannot go there this evening.	**Nous ne pouvons pas y aller ce soir.**
We cannot come this evening.	**Nous ne pouvons pas venir ce soir.**
to see	**voir**
We cannot see it.	**Nous ne pouvons pas le voir.**
They cannot see it.	**Ils ne peuvent pas le voir.**
They cannot see it. (*female group*)	**Elles ne peuvent pas le voir.**
They cannot see any of it.	**Ils ne peuvent pas en voir.**

NOTE! Don't forget that **peuvent** is pronounced "perv". The letters "**ent**" are silent here, as they are whenever "**ent**" comes at the end of a verb that follows "they".

to leave	**partir**
They cannot leave.	**Ils ne peuvent pas partir.**
tomorrow	**demain**
They cannot leave tomorrow.	**Ils ne peuvent pas partir demain.**
to go out	**sortir**
They cannot go out tomorrow.	**Ils ne peuvent pas sortir demain.**
I would like to know why they cannot go out tomorrow.	**Je voudrais savoir pourquoi ils ne peuvent pas sortir demain.**
to understand	**comprendre**
They cannot understand it.	**Ils ne peuvent pas le comprendre.**
They cannot understand me.	**Ils ne peuvent pas me comprendre.**
They cannot understand you.	**Ils ne peuvent pas vous comprendre.**
to sell	**vendre**
They cannot sell it.	**Ils ne peuvent pas le vendre.**
They cannot sell any of it.	**Ils ne peuvent pas en vendre.**

to wait	**attendre**
to wait for you	**vous attendre**
They cannot wait for you.	**Ils ne peuvent pas vous attendre.**
to wait for me	**m'attendre**
He can wait for me.	**Il peut m'attendre.**

NOTE! Make sure, when pronouncing these verbs that end in "**dre**", to pronounce the "**dre**" very clearly. It is pronounced like the "**dra**" at the end of the English name "Sandra".

"must"

I must go there with you.	**Je dois y aller avec vous.**
to prepare the dinner	**préparer le dîner**
I must prepare the dinner.	**Je dois préparer le dîner.**
to prepare it	**le préparer**
I must prepare it.	**Je dois le préparer.**
You must prepare it. (*inf.*)	**Tu dois le préparer.**
She must prepare it.	**Elle doit le préparer.**
She must find it.	**Elle doit le trouver.**
We must find it.	**Nous devons le trouver.**
We must find some (of it).	**Nous devons en trouver.**
You must buy some (of it).	**Vous devez en acheter.**
They must buy some (of it).	**Ils doivent en acheter.**
They must buy some (of it). (*female group*)	**Elles doivent en acheter.**

NOTE! Don't forget that **doivent** is pronounced "dwoirve". The letters "**ent**" are silent here, as they are whenever "**ent**" comes at the end of a verb that follows "they".

The present tense without "want", "can", "must" etc.

We will now take a look at the more general present tense in French – the present tense without "want", "can", "must" etc. By the end of this quick run-through, you will be able to use the vast majority of verbs in the French language, in the present tense, with almost no difficulty whatsoever. To do this, you need only to follow two very simple steps.

The first step: chop off the "r"! – Verbs ending in "er"
To use the present tense with verbs that end in "**er**" in French, simply chop off the "**r**" and pronounce the consonant at the end of the word. Let's take "to think" as an example.

to think	**penser**

In order to say *I think*, *he thinks*, *she thinks* etc., simply chop off the "**r**" from the end of **penser** and you are left with **pense** (pronounced rather like "ponse" in the English word *response*). Let's try a few examples:

I think / I am thinking	**Je pense**
He thinks / He is thinking	**Il pense**
She thinks / She is thinking	**Elle pense**

You see? Having simply ***chopped off the "r"*** from **penser**, we have discovered the present tense for *I*, *he* and *she*.

Chopping off the "**r**" also works for *you think* (*inf.*) and for *they think* in spoken French, as they both sound ***exactly*** the same as **pense** above. For those interested in learning to write the language, however, notice that there's a spelling change (although the pronunciation remains exactly the same as it is for the examples above). Let's take a look:

You think / You are thinking (*inf.*)	**Tu penses**
They think / They are thinking	**Ils pensent**
They think / They are thinking (*female group*)	**Elles pensent**

NOTE! As you will recall, the letters "**ent**" are silent whenever "**ent**" comes at the end of a verb that follows "they", and so **pensent** is still pronounced "pense" – exactly the same pronunciation as for the other spellings above.

Therefore, to find the present tense for *I*, *he*, *she*, *you* (*inf.*) and *they* – for verbs ending in "**er**" – simply chop off the "**r**" and pronounce the consonant at the end of the word.

The second step: swap the "r"! – Verbs ending in "er"

Chopping off the "**r**" above has given us the present tense for everything except *you* (*formal*) and *we*, which behave slightly differently from the others but which are also extremely straightforward. To work out how to say *you think / you are thinking*, you simply copy the sound of "to think".

to think	**penser**
You think / You are thinking	**Vous pensez**

Although spelt differently, **penser** and **pensez** are pronounced in exactly the same way, so if you know how to say *to think*, *to eat*, *to speak* etc., that means you also know how to say *you think*, *you eat*, *you speak* etc. They sound ***exactly*** the same, the only difference being in the spelling, because you ***swap the "r"*** at the end for a "**z**".

For *we think / we are thinking* you simply have an "**ons**" instead of an "**ez**" at the end.

You think / You are thinking	**Vous pensez**
We think / We are thinking	**Nous pensons**

NOTE! These patterns work in exactly the same way for all regular verbs ending in "**er**" in French – that's almost 90% of all verbs in the French language!

Let's take a look now at how this applies to the minority of verbs in French that don't end in "**er**".

The first step: chop off the "r"! – Verbs not ending in "er"

For regular French verbs that don't end in "**er**", again you simply ***chop off the "r"*** – along with any letters that follow it – but then you ***do not*** pronounce the last consonant at the end of the word. Let's take "to wait" as an example.

to wait	**attendre**

In order to say *he waits*, *she waits* etc., again simply ***chop off the "r"*** from the end of **attendre** – along with any letters that follow it – and you will be left with **attend**, pronounced "atton". Now, let's use it!

He waits / He is waiting	**Il attend**
She waits / She is waiting	**Elle attend**

As you can see, having simply ***chopped off the "r"*** – along with any letters that follow it – from **attendre**, we have once again discovered the present tense.

Chopping off the "**r**" also works for *I wait* and for *you wait* (*inf.*) in spoken French, as they both sound ***exactly*** the same as **attend** above. For those interested in learning to write the language, however, notice that there is a minor spelling change (although the pronunciation remains exactly the same as it is above).

I wait / I am waiting	**J'attends**
You wait / You are waiting (*inf.*)	**Tu attends**

This same step described above can be taken with countless other "non-**er**" verbs, for example "to finish".

to finish	**finir**

Again, you simply ***cut off the "r"*** and then make sure not to pronounce the consonant at the end of the word, if there is one. In the case of **finir** there will again be some spelling variations, as there are above, but each variation will be pronounced in exactly the same way; in this case they are all pronounced "fini".

I finish / I am finishing	**Je finis**
You finish / You are finishing (*inf.*)	**Tu finis**
He finishes / He is finishing	**Il finit**
She finishes / She is finishing	**Elle finit**

Again, therefore, for regular verbs that do not end in "**er**" (verbs ending in "**re**" or "**ir**", that is), simply ***chop off the "r"*** – along with any letters that follow it – but then ***do not*** pronounce the last consonant at the end of the word.

The second step: swap the "r"! – Verbs not ending in "er"

Returning to our first "non-**er**" verb example, **attendre**, you can see that chopping off the "**r**" above hasn't given us the present tense for *you* (*formal*) or for *we*, which behave slightly differently from the others. Fortunately, however, they are extremely straightforward because they follow exactly the same pattern as the "**er**" verbs earlier; simply swap the "**r**" – along with any letters that follow it – and replace them with either an "**ez**" for *you*, or an "**ons**" for *we*. Let's compare the "**er**" and the "non-**er**" verbs:

You think / You are thinking	**Vous pensez**
You wait / You are waiting	**Vous attendez**
We think / We are thinking	**Nous pensons**
We wait / We are waiting	**Nous attendons**

NOTE! As you can see, the *you* form simply ends with "**ez**" and the *we* form with "**ons**". This is the same in both the "**er**" and "non-**er**" groups and so should be easy to remember.

The future

Using "going to" / "aller" to express the future

"Going to" can be used in essentially the same way as it is in English in order to express what you are "going to" do in the future. It is very easy to get the hang of, as you will see!

to go	**aller**
You are going	**Vous allez**
We are going	**Nous allons**
I am going	**Je vais**
He is going	**Il va**
She is going	**Elle va**
You are going (*inf.*)	**Tu vas**
They are going	**Ils vont**
They are going (*female group*)	**Elles vont**
to eat	**manger**
I'm going to eat.	**Je vais manger.**
I'm going to eat it.	**Je vais le manger.**
I am going to go there.	**Je vais y aller.**
later	**plus tard**
I'm going to go there later.	**Je vais y aller plus tard.**
He is going to prepare	**Il va préparer**
He is going to prepare the dinner.	**Il va préparer le dîner.**
He is going to go out this evening.	**Il va sortir ce soir.**
She is going to leave this evening.	**Elle va partir ce soir.**
to stay	**rester**
You are going to stay here this evening.	**Vous allez rester ici ce soir.**
You are going to stay here this evening. (*inf.*)	**Tu vas rester ici ce soir.**
We are going to take it.	**Nous allons le prendre.**
They are going to take it.	**Ils vont le prendre.**
They are going to take it. (*female group*)	**Elles vont le prendre.**

Using "going to" / "aller" in questions

Are you going to prepare dinner this evening?	**Est-ce que vous allez préparer le dîner ce soir? / Allez-vous préparer le dîner ce soir? / Vous allez préparer le dîner ce soir?**
Are you going to prepare dinner this evening? (*inf.*)	**Est-ce que tu vas préparer le dîner ce soir? / Vas-tu préparer le dîner ce soir? / Tu vas préparer le dîner ce soir?**

Using "will" to express the future

There are two main ways to express the future in French. The first is by using "going to", which we have just looked at above; the second is by using "will". "Going to" and "will" are relatively interchangeable in spoken French, so in general you will be able to use whichever you prefer when speaking the language. In formal written French, however, there is a preference for "will".

Let's learn about this tense now.

NOTE! The key to using "will" correctly is simply to hook the appropriate version of "have/has" onto the "**r**" at the end of a verb.

I have	**J'ai**

Therefore "have", for "I" / **je**, is "**ai**".

Hook this "**ai**" onto the "**r**" at the end of a verb, such as "to eat", which is **manger**, and you will get **manger<u>ai</u>**, which means *will eat*.

I will eat.	**Je mangerai.**

"To leave" is **partir**.

I will leave	**Je partirai.**

"To speak" is **parler**.

I will speak	**Je parlerai**

We can also make "he will" simply by looking at "he has":

He has	**Il a**

Again, we simply hook the **a** onto the "**r**" at the end of the verb.

He will leave	**Il partira**
He will eat	**Il mangera**
He will speak	**Il parlera**

Let's look now at *you have* and *we have*.

You have	**Vous avez**
We have	**Nous avons**

For *you* and *we*, you will use only the ends of the words for "have". For *you* take the "**ez**" from **avez**, and for *we* take the "**ons**" from **avons**, and then hook them onto the "**r**" at the end of the verb.

You will leave.	**Vous partirez.**
You will eat.	**Vous mangerez.**
You will speak.	**Vous parlerez.**
We will leave.	**Nous partirons.**
We will eat.	**Nous mangerons.**
We will speak.	**Nous parlerons.**
They have	**Ils ont**
They will leave.	**Ils partiront.**
They will eat.	**Ils mangeront.**

They will speak.	**Ils parler**ont.
They will speak with you tomorrow.	**Ils parler**ont **avec vous demain.**
You have (*inf.*)	**Tu as**
You will leave. (*inf.*)	**Tu partir**as.
You will eat. (*inf.*)	**Tu manger**as.
You will speak. (*inf.*)	**Tu parler**as.

As you can see, this is not so difficult, as long as you know the French for "have/has". In terms of pronunciation, the key sound at the end of these words is the "have/has" hooked onto the "**r**". It is important to make this "**r**" sound clear.

For *I will* and *you will* the key sound at the end of the words is "Ray" – they are spelt differently ("**rai**" and "**rez**" respectively) but are pronounced in the same way.

For *we will* and *they will* the key sound at the end of the words is "Ron" – they are spelt differently ("**rons**" and "**ront**" respectively) but are pronounced in the same way.

For *he will*, *she will* and *they will* (*inf.*) the key sound at the end of the words is "Ra".

So, in terms of the sounds you will hear at the end of the words, remember that ***it will always be either Ray, Ron or (the Sun God) Ra leading you into the future*** – without exception!

Let's look at a few examples:

I will eat with you later.	**Je manger**ai **avec vous plus tard.**
We will eat with you tomorrow morning.	**Nous manger**ons **avec vous demain matin.**
He will leave this evening.	**Il partir**a **ce soir.**

Let's try it with another verb, this time one ending in "**dre**". Again, simply hook the correct endings onto the "**r**".

I will wait.	**J'attendrai.**
I will wait for you.	**Je vous attendrai.**
He will wait for you.	**Il vous attendra.**
He will wait for me.	**Il m'attendra.**
He won't wait for me.	**Il ne m'attendra pas.**
She won't wait for me this evening.	**Elle ne m'attendra pas ce soir.**

Travelling in France

You now have a chance to use what you have learnt to deal with those everyday situations you are likely to come across when travelling in a French-speaking country.

You will be familiar with the scenarios below from their use on the audio. The best way to use them here is in the same way as in the core course review above: first read through a scenario, looking at both the English and the French, and then go back to the beginning of that same scenario and, while covering the French side of the text, translate the English into French – just as you did when you listened to the audio.

At the hotel

Traveller	I would like a room for two people for two nights.	**Je voudrais une chambre pour deux personnes pour deux nuits.**
Receptionist	I have a room for two people with (a) shower.	**J'ai une chambre pour deux personnes avec douche.**
Traveller	It's how much?	**C'est combien?**
Receptionist	For two nights, with breakfast... 100 euros.	**Pour deux nuits, avec petit déjeuner... cent euros.**
Traveller	Can I see it (her)?	**Je peux la voir?**
Receptionist	Yes.	**Oui.**

You are taken up to see the room; it's not bad.

Traveller	Ah yes, it's perfect!	**Ah oui, c'est parfait!**

You go back downstairs to reception.

Receptionist	Your name, please?	**Votre nom, s'il vous plaît?**
Traveller	Say and then spell your name. (See page 60 for spelling guidance.)	
Receptionist	How are you paying?	**Comment payez-vous?**
Traveller	Can I pay by (with a) credit card?	**Je peux payer avec une carte de crédit?**
Receptionist	Yes.	**Oui.**

The receptionist then takes your card, and you enter your PIN.

Traveller	Thank you.	**Merci.**
Receptionist	Thank you.	**Merci.**

Eating out

On the telephone

Traveller	I would like to reserve a table for two people.	**Je voudrais réserver une table pour deux personnes.**
Restaurant	For this evening?	**Pour ce soir?**
Traveller	Yes, for seven o'clock.	**Oui, pour sept heures.**
Restaurant	Your name, please.	**Votre nom, s'il vous plaît.**
Traveller	Say and then spell your name. (See page 60 for spelling guidance.)	
Restaurant	Thank you, bye.	**Merci, au revoir.**

Later, at the hotel reception

Traveller	Where is it that I can get a taxi?	**Où est-ce que je peux prendre un taxi?**

The concierge flags one down for you and you get in.

Traveller	The Louvre, please.	**Le Louvre, s'il vous plaît.**

The taxi arrives outside the Louvre, just opposite the restaurant.

Traveller	Keep the change.	**Gardez la monnaie.**
Taxi driver	Thanks.	**Merci.**

You cross the road and enter the restaurant.

Traveller	We have reserved (a table).	**Nous avons réservé.**

You are seated, given a menu and decide to order something inexpensive.

Traveller	A bottle of white wine and two dishes of the day, please.	**Une bouteille de vin blanc et deux plats du jour, s'il vous plaît.**

You finish your meal but have clearly drunk too much wine.

Traveller	Where are the toilets?	**Où sont les toilettes?**

The waiter gestures in their direction and, later, after you come back:

Waiter	Would you like (Desire you to take) a coffee?	**Désirez-vous prendre un café?**
Traveller	Yes, two coffees and the bill, please.	**Oui, deux cafés et l'addition, s'il vous plaît.**

At the tourist office / Getting directions

In the street

Traveller	Excuse me, where is the tourist office?	**Pardon, où est l'office du tourisme?**
Parisian	The tourist office is opposite the cathedral, over there. It's signposted (indicated).	**L'office du tourisme est en face de la cathédrale, là-bas. C'est indiqué.**

In the tourist office

Traveller	I would like to visit Chartres. Do you have a guide?	**Je voudrais visiter Chartres. Vous avez un guide?**
Tourist officer	Yes, we have a guide of the region.	**Oui, nous avons un guide de la région.**
Traveller	How much is it?	**C'est combien.**
Tourist officer	Five euros.	**Cinq euros.**

You pay and take the guide.

Traveller	Thank you.	**Merci.**

Back outside

Traveller	Excuse me, in order to get to the train station?	**Pardon, pour aller à la gare?**
Parisian	Continue straight on, after the cathedral turn right – no, no, sorry, left.	**Continuez tout droit, après la cathédrale tournez à droite – non, non, pardon, à gauche.**
Traveller	Thank you.	**Merci.**

Taking a train

At the train station

Traveller	Where can I buy a ticket?	**Où est-ce que je peux acheter un billet?**
Station employee	Over there.	**Là-bas.**
Traveller	Thank you.	**Merci.**

In the ticket office

Traveller	Two tickets for Chartres, please.	**Deux billets pour Chartres, s'il vous plaît.**
Ticket clerk	Single or return?	**Aller simple ou aller-retour?**
Traveller	Return, please.	**Aller-retour, s'il vous plaît.**
	Do I have to change (trains)?	**Dois-je changer?**
Ticket clerk	No, it's not necessary.	**Non, ce n'est pas nécessaire.**
	Eighteen euros, please.	**Dix-huit euros, s'il vous plaît.**

You pay and she hands you your tickets.

Ticket clerk	Your tickets.	**Vos billets.**
Traveller	Thank you.	**Merci.**

On the platform

Traveller	This is the train for Chartres?	**C'est le train pour Chartres?**
Station guard	No, the train for Chartres is over there.	**Non, le train pour Chartres est là-bas.**

Some time later, on a train headed for Chartres

Conductor	Prepare your tickets, please.	**Préparez vos billets, s'il vous plaît.**

To another passenger, who has brought a bicycle on board:

Conductor	You must pay a supplement.	**Vous devez payer un supplément.**

Finally, he reaches the area where you are sitting.

Conductor	Tickets, please.	**Billets, s'il vous plaît.**

A while later, as the train slows down, you ask another passenger:

Traveller	I'm going to Chartres. Do I have to get off (descend) here?	**Je vais à Chartres. Dois-je descendre ici?**
Passenger	Yes.	**Oui.**

You get off the train.

A brief encounter

Outside, looking for the market

Traveller	Excuse me, is there a market here?	**Pardon, est-ce qu'il y a un marché ici?**

The gentleman you ask replies but you do not understand.

Traveller	I don't understand. Can you repeat that, please?	**Je ne comprends pas. Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît?**

Again, you do not understand because he speaks so quickly.

Traveller	Can you speak more slowly, please?	**Pouvez-vous parler plus lentement, s'il vous plaît?**

He tries again, this time more slowly.

Man in the street	Go straight down there, turn left after the cathedral.	**Continuez tout droit, après la cathédrale tournez à gauche.**
Traveller	Ah, I understand. Thank you.	**Ah, je comprends. Merci.**

You are about to leave but he continues talking to you.

Man in the street	Where are you from?	**Vous êtes d'où?**

You say where you are from.

Traveller	I'm from ..... And you?	**Je suis de ..... Et vous?**
Man in the street	I'm from Toulouse. I'm Jacques.	**Je suis de Toulouse. Je suis Jacques.**

You tell him your name.

Traveller	I'm	**Je suis .....**

You note how smartly dressed he is and ask him what it is he does.

Traveller	What do you do? / What is your profession?	**Quelle est votre profession?**
Man in the street	I'm (a) civil servant. And you?	**Je suis fonctionnaire. Et vous?**

You tell him your profession.

Traveller	I'm a	**Je suis .....**

He looks at his watch.

Man in the street	I'm sorry but I must go/leave. Goodbye.	**Je regrette mais je dois partir. Au revoir.**
Traveller	Bye.	**Au revoir.**

Shopping at the market

At the first stall

Traveller	Can you help me?	**Pouvez-vous m'aider?**
First stallholder	What would you like?	**Qu'est-ce que vous désirez?**
Traveller	Do you have any cheese?	**Est-ce que vous avez du fromage?**
First stallholder	Yes.	**Oui.**
Traveller	I would like 200 grams of brie.	**Je voudrais deux cent grammes de brie.**
	Do you have a bag?	**Vous avez un sac?**

He gives you a bag.

First stallholder	That's all?	**C'est tout?**
Traveller	Yes, that's all. How much is it?	**Oui, c'est tout. C'est combien?**
First stallholder	Ten euros.	**Dix euros.**

At the second stall

Second stallholder	Can I help you?	**Je peux vous aider?**
Traveller	I would like a baguette, please.	**Je voudrais une baguette, s'il vous plaît.**
Second stallholder	There you go. That's all?	**Voilà. C'est tout?**

Traveller	No, I would like an éclair.	**Non, je voudrais un éclair.**
Second stallholder	I'm sorry, we don't have any.	**Je suis désolé, nous n'en avons pas.**
Traveller	Okay, how much is it?	**Ah bon, c'est combien?**
Second stallholder	Two euros.	**Deux euros.**

You pay and go off to eat your bread and cheese.

Seeing a doctor

Feeling unwell, you go down to the reception in your hotel.

Traveller	I'm ill. Can you recommend me a doctor?	**Je suis malade. Pouvez-vous me recommander un docteur?**
Receptionist	Is it urgent?	**C'est urgent?**
Traveller	Yes, it's very urgent – and can the doctor come here?	**Oui, c'est très urgent – et est-ce que le docteur peut venir ici?**
Receptionist	Yes, one moment please.	**Oui, un moment, s'il vous plaît.**
Receptionist	He is going to come immediately (tout de suite).	**Il va venir tout de suite.**

The doctor arrives a while later and comes to your room.

Doctor	What's wrong? / What are your symptoms?	**Quels sont vos symptômes?**
Traveller	I have been sick.	**J'ai vomi.**
Doctor	Do you have a fever?	**Avez-vous de la fièvre?**
Traveller	Yes.	**Oui.**
Doctor	Since when?	**Depuis quand?**
Traveller	For (since) two hours.	**Depuis deux heures.**
Doctor	Can you tell me... Are you diabetic?	**Pouvez-vous me dire... Êtes-vous diabétique?**
Traveller	No.	**Non.**

Doctor	Do you have a heart condition?	**Êtes-vous cardiaque?**
Traveller	No.	**Non.**
Doctor	Are you asthmatic?	**Êtes-vous asthmatique?**
Traveller	No.	**Non.**

He examines you further and then decides.

Doctor	You have sunstroke.	**Vous avez une insolation.**
Traveller	Is it serious?	**C'est grave?**
Doctor	No, it's not very serious but you mustn't go out today.	**Non, ce n'est pas très grave mais vous ne devez pas sortir aujourd'hui.**

He leaves you some rehydration salts and says goodbye.

Traveller	Thank you, goodbye.	**Merci, au revoir.**

Finding a campsite

Traveller	Where is the camping site?	**Où est le camping?**
Passerby	The camping site's over there!	**Le camping est là-bas.**

You walk over to someone who appears to be a farmer / campsite owner.

Traveller	Can we camp here?	**Pouvons-nous camper ici?**
Farmer	Yes, you can camp here.	**Oui, vous pouvez camper ici.**
Traveller	For one night, it's how much?	**Pour une nuit, c'est combien?**
Farmer	Caravan ten euros, tent five euros.	**Caravane dix euros, tente cinq euros.**
Traveller	I have a tent and I would like to stay for three nights.	**J'ai une tente et je voudrais rester pour trois nuits.**
Farmer	Fifteen euros.	**Quinze euros.**

Taking a taxi

Traveller	The Louvre, please.	**Le Louvre, s'il vous plaît.**
	It's how much?	**C'est combien?**
Driver	Ten euros.	**Dix euros.**
Traveller	Keep the change!	**Gardez la monnaie!**

At a café

Waiter	What would you like? (You desire?)	**Vous désirez?**
Traveller	A coffee, please.	**Un café, s'il vous plaît.**
Traveller 2	For me, a white wine and a sandwich, please.	**Pour moi, un vin blanc et un sandwich, s'il vous plaît.**
Traveller	It's how much?	**C'est combien?**
Waiter	Six euros.	**Six euros.**

Taking a bus

Traveller	Where can I buy a ticket?	**Où est-ce que je peux acheter un billet?**
Bus driver	Over there.	**Là-bas.**
Traveller	A ticket for Bordeaux, please.	**Un billet pour Bordeaux, s'il vous plaît.**
Ticket office clerk	Single or return?	**Aller simple ou aller-retour?**
Traveller	Return please.	**Aller-retour, s'il vous plaît.**
Ticket office clerk	Twelve euros, please.	**Douze euros, s'il vous plaît.**

Introducing yourself

Traveller	I'm ..... I'm from..... And you?	**Je suis .....** **Je suis de .....** **Et vous?**
Marion	I'm Marion. I'm from Normandy.	**Je suis Marion. Je suis de Normandie.**
Traveller	What do you do? / What is your profession?	**Quelle est votre profession?**
Marion	I'm (a) teacher.	**Je suis professeur.**

At the bakery

Baker	What would you like? (You desire?)	**Vous désirez?**
Traveller	A baguette, please.	**Une baguette, s'il vous plaît.**
Baker	That's all?	**C'est tout?**
Traveller	No. Two croissants and a pain au chocolat.	**Non. Deux croissants et un pain au chocolat.**
Baker	That's all ?	**C'est tout?**
Traveller	Yes, that's all.	**Oui, c'est tout.**
Baker	Four euros, please.	**Quatre euros, s'il vous plaît.**

At the pharmacy

Traveller	I am ill.	**Je suis malade.**
Pharmacist	What's wrong? / What are your symptoms?	**Quels sont vos symptômes?**
Traveller	I have been sick.	**J'ai vomi.**
Pharmacist	Do you have a fever?	**Avez-vous de la fièvre?**
Traveller	Yes.	**Oui.**
Pharmacist	You have sunstroke and I think that you should (must) see a doctor.	**Vous avez une insolation et je pense que vous devez voir un docteur.**

Essential verbs: a snapshot

I go / I am going	**je vais**
he goes / he is going	**il va**
she goes/ she is going	**elle va**
you go / you are going (*inf.*)	**tu vas**
you go / you are going	**vous allez**
we go / we are going	**nous allons**
they go / they are going	**ils vont**
they go/ they are going (*f*)	**elles vont**
Root verb (to go)	**aller**

I have	**j'ai**
he has	**il a**
she has	**elle a**
you have (*inf.*)	**tu as**
you have	**vous avez**
we have	**nous avons**
they have	**ils ont**
they have (*f*)	**elles ont**
Root verb (to have)	**avoir**

I must	**je dois**
he must	**il doit**
she must	**elle doit**
you must (*inf.*)	**tu dois**
you must	**vous devez**
we must	**nous devons**
they must	**ils doivent** (pronounced *dwoirve*)
they must (*f*)	**ils doivent** (pronounced *dwoirve*)
Root verb (must/have to)	**devoir**

I am	**je suis**
he is	**il est**
she is	**elle est**
you are (*inf.*)	**tu es**
you are	**vous êtes**
we are	**nous sommes**
they are	**ils sont**
they are (*f*)	**elles sont**
Root verb (to be)	**être**

I can	**je peux**
he can	**il peut**
she can	**elle peut**
you can (*inf.*)	**tu peux**
you can	**vous pouvez**
we can	**nous pouvons**
they can	**ils peuvent** (pronounced *perv*)
they can (*f*)	**elles peuvent**
Root verb (can / to be able to)	**pouvoir**

I want	**je veux**
he wants	**il veut**
she wants	**elle veut**
you want (*inf.*)	**tu veux**
you want	**vous voulez**
we want	**nous voulons**
they want	**ils veulent** (pronounced *vurl*)
they want (*f*)	**elles veulent**
Root verb (to want)	**vouloir**

Numbers

You can listen to all these numbers in chapter 31 of the audio for the correct pronunciation.

0	**zéro**
1	**un**
2	**deux**
3	**trois**
4	**quatre**
5	**cinq**
6	**six**
7	**sept**
8	**huit**
9	**neuf**
10	**dix**
11	**onze**
12	**douze**
13	**treize**
14	**quatorze**
15	**quinze**
16	**seize**
17	**dix-sept**
18	**dix-huit**
19	**dix-neuf**
20	**vingt**
21	**vingt et un**
22	**vingt-deux**
23	**vingt-trois**
24	**vingt-quatre**
25	**vingt-cinq**
26	**vingt-six**
27	**vingt-sept**
28	**vingt-huit**
29	**vingt-neuf**
30	**trente**
31	**trente et un**
32	**trente-deux**
33	**trente-trois**
34	**trente-quatre**
35	**trente-cinq**
36	**trente-six**
37	**trente-sept**
38	**trente-huit**
39	**trente-neuf**
40	**quarante**
41	**quarante et un**
42	**quarante-deux**
43	**quarante-trois**
44	**quarante-quatre**
45	**quarante-cinq**
46	**quarante-six**
47	**quarante-sept**
48	**quarante-huit**
49	**quarante-neuf**
50	**cinquante**
51	**cinquante et un**
52	**cinquante-deux**
53	**cinquante-trois**
54	**cinquante-quatre**
55	**cinquante-cinq**
56	**cinquante-six**
57	**cinquante-sept**
58	**cinquante-huit**
59	**cinquante-neuf**

60 **soixante**
61 **soixante et un**
62 **soixante-deux**
63 **soixante-trois**
64 **soixante-quatre**
65 **soixante-cinq**
66 **soixante-six**
67 **soixante-sept**
68 **soixante-huit**
69 **soixante-neuf**
70 **soixante-dix**
71 **soixante et onze**
72 **soixante-douze**
73 **soixante-treize**
74 **soixante-quatorze**
75 **soixante-quinze**
76 **soixante-seize**
77 **soixante-dix-sept**
78 **soixante-dix-huit**
79 **soixante-dix-neuf**
80 **quatre vingts**
81 **quatre-vingt-un**
82 **quatre-vingt-deux**
83 **quatre-vingt-trois**
84 **quatre-vingt-quatre**
85 **quatre-vingt-cinq**
86 **quatre-vingt-six**
87 **quatre-vingt-sept**
88 **quatre-vingt-huit**
89 **quatre-vingt-neuf**
90 **quatre-vingt-dix**
91 **quatre-vingt-onze**
92 **quatre-vingt-douze**
93 **quatre-vingt-treize**
94 **quatre-vingt-quatorze**
95 **quatre-vingt-quinze**
96 **quatre-vingt-seize**
97 **quatre-vingt-dix-sept**
98 **quatre-vingt-dix-huit**
99 **quatre-vingt-dix-neuf**
100 **cent**
101 **cent un**
102 **cent deux**
103 **cent trois**
104 **cent quatre**
105 **cent cinq**
106 **cent six**
107 **cent sept**
108 **cent huit**
109 **cent neuf**
110 **cent dix**
111 **cent onze**
112 **cent douze**
113 **cent treize**
114 **cent quatorze**
115 **cent quinze**
116 **cent seize**
117 **cent dix-sept**
118 **cent dix-huit**
119 **cent dix-neuf**
120 **cent vingt**
121 **cent vingt et un**
122 **cent vingt-deux**

and so on...

130	**cent trente**
140	**cent quarante**
200	**deux cents**
201	**deux cent un**
202	**deux cent deux**
250	**deux cent cinquante**
1000	**mille**
1001	**mille un**
2000	**deux mille**
50,000	**cinquante mille**
500,000	**cinq cent mille**
1,000,000	**un million**

The alphabet

You can listen to the entire French alphabet in chapter 32 of the audio for the correct pronunciation.

Letter	Pronounced in French as
A	**ah**
B	**bay**
C	**say**
D	**day**
E	**uh**
F	**ef**
G	**zhay (or the French j'ai)**
H	**ash**
I	**ee**
J	**zhee**
K	**kah**
L	**ell**
M	**emm**
N	**enn**
O	**oh**
P	**pay**

Q	**kew (Round your lips as though you are going to whistle, but instead of whistling say the English word "key" while keeping your lips in the rounded, whistling position.)**
R	**ehr**
S	**ess**
T	**tay**
U	**ew (Round your lips as though you are going to whistle, but instead of whistling say the English letter "e" while keeping your lips in the rounded, whistling position.)**
V	**vay**
W	**doo-bluh-vay**
X	**eex**
Y	**ee-grek**
Z	**zed**

Audio track order

Part 1

Topic	Key elements
Welcome	
Ground rules	Relax and don't worry if you forget
Entente cordiale	The similarities between French and English
The past with have	Including: *I have*, *you have*, *have you?*
You have	A question of pronunciation
He has, she has	Plus *your*
-ation words and the café E	1,250 easy French words
Three into one will go	*I have decorated*, *I decorated*, *I did decorate*
To prepare	Plus *I would like*, *hungry*, *thirsty*
The 'For luck' rule	Knowing when to pronounce consonants on the end of words
Finding French words	Including *chambre*, *personne*, *nuit*
-ic and -icle words	Plus *it is*
Do you want?	Plus *to know*, *if*

Topic	Key elements
It's not	Forming the negative
Another way of asking questions	A question of intonation; plus *why*, *with*
I haven't	Using the negative in the past; plus *I'm sorry but ...*
Putting 'it' in its place	An introduction to pronouns; plus *can*, *do*, *today*
More questions	*Est-ce que?* – a third way of asking questions in French; plus *we can*
They	*Ils peuvent*; *plus me*
To see	Plus *her*
A different kind of 'it'	Masculine and feminine; plus *breakfast*, *perfect*
How much is it?	Plus *name*, *to stay*, *to pay*
Numbers 1–20	
Booking a hotel room	Plus *euros* and spelling your name
Where is it?	Plus *there*, *over there* and some camping vocabulary

Topic	Key elements
Carry on camping	A review of *can* and the negative
Using what you know 1	Booking a campsite
You and you	Formal (*vous*) and informal (*tu*)
A question of understanding 1	*Comprendre* with *me* and *vous*
Verbs	How to recognise them; plus the different endings
Wanting	*Vouloir*; plus *now*
Leaving	*Partir*
They want	Plus *to take*
Female groups	*Elles*
Ordering drinks	*Vous désirez?*, *l'addition*
Giving instructions	Including *keep the change*, ordering food and wine
Using what you know 2	Taking a taxi
Using what you know 3	At the café
A little practice 1	*Je veux* and *je peux*; plus this evening
A little formality	When to use *tu*
Where?	Practising asking questions
Using 'are'	Plus some pronunciation options

Part 2

Topic	Key elements
Telling the time	Plus *we have*
Using what you know 4	Eating out
A little practice 2	*Can*
Some and any	Using *en*
Going	*Aller*
'Proxy nouns'	Understanding pronouns
Here and there	Using *y*
Doing your duty 1	*I/you/he/she/we must*; plus *to wait for*
Doing your duty 2	*They must*
A little practice 3	*Devoir*
Asking the way 1	*Opposite*, *signposted*; plus *office du tourisme*
At the tourist office	*Of the*; plus asking for a map

Topic	Key elements
Asking the way 2	*Straight ahead*; plus *pour aller à*
Asking the way 3	*To the right*, *to the left*; plus *tourner*, *après*
Using what you know 5	Finding your way
More and more	*Later*, *bigger*, *smaller*
A little practice 4	*Devoir*; plus *acheter*
A little practice 5	*Où*; plus *billet*; *aller simple*, *aller-retour*, *ou*
Using what you know 6	Buying a ticket
On the train	*Changer*, words ending *-ary*, *descendre*, *supplément*
A little practice 6	*Devoir*, *pouvoir* and *vouloir*
A little practice 7	*Aller*
Going, going	*Je vais*, *tu vas*, *il/elle va*, *ils/elles vont*
Still going	Plus *à*, *vos*, *expirer*
A little practice 8	On the move
Using what you know 7	A train trip
Best intentions	Using *aller* for the future; plus *partir*

Topic	Key elements
The 'have-stealing' rule	The position of pronouns in the past; plus *they have*
Déjà-vu	The past of *voir* and *vendre*
To have and to have not	Working with negatives in the past
Waiting game	Using *attendre*
Where are you from?	*De*, *you are*; plus *busy*, *determined*, *Londres*
What is your profession?	*Quel est?*; plus common professions
Using what you know 8	Introducing yourself
There is	*Il y a*
A question of understanding 2	Using *comprendre*
A question of understanding 3	Using *répéter*
A question of understanding 4	*Parler plus lentement*
Using what you know 9	Making contact
Pronunciation practice	*Ils ont* and *elles ont*

Topic	Key elements
A little practice 9	The past
An exception	*Compris*, *pris*
A little practice 10	*Comprendre* and *pouvoir*
A little practice 11	*En*
A little practice 12	*Vouloir*
A little practice 13	*Devoir*
A little practice 14	Using *aller* with *le* and *la*
A little practice 15	*C'est*; plus *tout*
May Day	*Aider*; plus French food
'Desolation'	*Désolé*; plus practising *it* and *some of it*
Using what you know 10	Shopping at the market
A little practice 16	Pronouns and *avoir*

Part 3

Topic	Key elements
To be	*Être*
A little practice 17	Pronouns in the past
A different past	How to use *être* in the past
Coming and going 1	When to use *être*
Coming and going 2	More *être* verbs
Coming and going 3	In the negative; plus *hier*
Coming and going 4	With *y*
A little practice 18	Some common verbs
I think, therefore I am thinking	*Penser*; plus forming the present tense
I think that ...	Introducing *que*
Feeling unwell	Explaining what's wrong
At the doctor's	More symptoms; plus *since when?*, *a moment, please*
Using what you know 11	At the pharmacy
A little practice 19	Coming and going; *plus tout de suite*, *grave*, more maladies
Using what you know 12	Calling the doctor

Topic	Key elements
One can	Using *on peut*
'One' meaning 'we'	Using *on veut*
A little practice 20	*Vouloir* and *pouvoir*
A little practice 21	Asking for and giving directions
A little practice 22	Travelling by train
A little practice 23	Asking the way
A little practice 24	*Devoir* and *avoir*
A little practice 25	*Aller*
A little practice 26	*Avoir* and the past tense with *avoir*
A little practice 27	*Etre* and the past tense with *être*
Only one present	Forming and using the present tense
The present in detail	The two groups of present tense words; plus *donner*
His and hers	Using *le* and *la* to mean, 'it', 'him' and 'her'
'L is for last'	Getting *me*, *le* and *lui* in the right order

Topic	Key elements
Giving them to them	*Les* and *leur*
Us and you	*Nous* and *vous* as pronouns
Going to	The future with *aller*
Another future	Forming the 'will' tense 1
'Ray', 'Ron' and 'Ra'	Forming the 'will' tense 2
On leave	The future of *partir*
A little practice 28	The future of *parler*
Wait for me	The future of *attendre*
A little practice 29	The future of *donner*
Numbers	With English prompts
Numbers	In French only
The French alphabet	Learn to spell in French
Goodbye	

Review

Topic
Introduction
At the hotel and campsite
Eating and drinking
Finding the way
Travelling by train
What you are, where you are from
Asking questions
Shopping
At the doctor's
I have, you have
He has, he did
I would like 1
I would like 2

Review

Topic	
I would like 3; plus '-ic' words	*-er* verbs in the present
I would like 4	*-er* and *-ir* verbs in the future
To have and to have not	it/him/her/them in the future
Devoir, *pouvoir*, *vouloir*	
Aller	
Avoir	
Can do; want to; it/him/her/them in the present	
It/me in the past	
The past with *être*	
The future with *aller*	
-ic words; at the campsite and hotel	
At the café/restaurant	
Where oh where?	
Moving on	
Être	
Out and about	
Shopping	
Not feeling well	